

01 Install it (5 minutes, once)

1 · Host

Put `margin.html` in a folder, rename it `index.html`, and drag the folder onto Netlify Drop while signed in.

2 · Open

Open the site link in Chrome on the Pixel.

3 · Pin

Chrome menu $\vdots$ → *Add to Home screen*. The icon opens straight to the capture box.

4 · Seed

Tap *Set up now*. Enter the expiry dates you have, then tell it when each dog treatment was last done.

Keep the same web address. Your data is tied to it. To update Margin later, drag the new folder onto that site's *Deploys* page, not onto a new Drop. A new address opens an empty app. Sites dropped without signing in are temporary and must be claimed within an hour.

02 How alerts work

A web app can't reliably ping you when it's closed. So Margin passes anything time-critical to Google Calendar, and your phone sends the alert from there.

THE TEST

Does the item have a **clock time**, a **!**, or an **expiry date**?

Yes → Hard ♦

A red → *Calendar* button appears. One tap creates the event, with repeats included where the rule allows. The row shows “in calendar” once sent, and “send to cal” again if you move it.

No → Soft

It stays in Margin, slotted into your day (commute, home, after bedtime). Once late, it moves to the top, turns bold after 3 days and gets a red underline after 7.

PUSHED 3 TIMES? Margin stops offering snooze and asks you to pick:

DO IT NOW

DELEGATE

FIRM DATE

SOMEDAY

DROP

In Google Calendar → Settings, set a default notification (e.g. **10 min before**, and **09:00 the day before** for all-day events). Expiry warnings arrive as all-day events.

03 What you can type

FOR

WRITE

When	today tonight tmrw tue next tue this weekend next week in 3 days 12 oct 12/10 end of month
Your slots	commute 08:00 · at office 08:45 · lunch 12:30 · leaving 16:50 · when home 17:30 · after bedtime 20:00 · weekends: morning midday afternoon evening
Clock time	5pm 17:30 at 5 noon . These make the item hard.
Repeat	daily monthly every 2 weeks every tue and thu every weekday
After done	every 30 days after done . The next date counts from when you tick it.
Seasonal	every year before summer · before ramadan (approx. dates) · back to school · cooler months · year end
Expiry	expires 12 mar 2027 expires 3/27 expires in 6 months . Warnings at 60 / 30 / 7 days.
Lists	buy ... on noon · gift for Wife ... · waiting on Ahmed for ... · ... someday
Tags	#dogs #george #admin ... · @name · effort ~2m ~15m ~deep · ! forces hard

Before you tap +, chips under the box show what Margin understood. Tap the area chip to change it. Margin learns from the change and files similar items there next time.

04 Where it fits in your day



DAILY · FROM 20:00

Evening triage (2 min)

- 1 Empty the inbox: give each item an area and a when.
- 2 Overdue: move to a real day, park or drop.
- 3 Tomorrow: check the list is realistic. Add anything missing.

WEEKLY · SUN 09:30

Weekly review (10 min)

- 1 Stuck items: overdue, or pushed twice or more
- 2 Waiting on: chase or close
- 3 Next 7 days: flags any day with 6+ items
- 4 Expiry radar: next 90 days, plus undated items
- 5 Someday pile: keep, schedule, kill · 6 Back up

Review tab → Put both rituals in Google Calendar sets up two repeating events, so the reminder to open Margin comes from your calendar. Change the times in Settings.

05 Handing things off

SEND

Item → Send via WhatsApp. Pick wife, George's nanny or the dogs' nanny. The message is pre-written.

WAIT

The item moves to Lists → Waiting with a chase date (3 days by default).

CHASE

On that date it shows in Today. One tap sends a polite nudge and resets the date.

CLOSE

Got it logs it as done.

Add phone numbers under Settings → WhatsApp contacts to skip WhatsApp's contact picker. Share list on the Buy tab sends the whole list grouped by shop.

06 Small things that save time

FEATURE	WHAT IT DOES
Time I have filter	Waiting in a queue? Tap 2 min to see only quick items. Effort is guessed from the first word (call, book, plan...).
Batch card	Appears when 3+ similar items are due (calls, payments, bookings), so you can clear them in one sitting.
Done log search	Notes → search "AC" shows last done 3 Jun (105 days ago) and the dates before that.
Someday resurfacing	Every 21 days, two parked ideas come back to keep, schedule or kill, so the pile stays small.
Expiry radar	Ahead tab → a 180-day track for each document, with warning ticks. Tap Renewed to log it and enter the new expiry date.
Long-press icon	Shortcuts to voice capture, pasting a source, the Buy list and the radar, where Chrome supports them.

07 · YOUR DATA

Everything is stored in Chrome on this phone, under the site's address. Nothing syncs. **Every Sunday, your first tap saves a backup file to Downloads.** A red banner appears after 14 days without one. Restore under Settings → Data. Clearing Chrome's site data, or moving to a new address, starts Margin from empty, so restore from the latest backup. Voice capture uses Chrome's speech service and needs a connection. Ramadan dates are estimates.

08 Four ways things get in

Most of what you have to do arrives somewhere else first — an email, an invite, a message, a list someone sent you. The *Sources* tab is where those land. Margin reads them on the phone, suggests items, and waits for you.

1 · Paste

Forward or copy an email, then paste it into the box and tap *Read it*. Works with anything: a message, an invite, a list.

2 · Gmail

Read-only, straight from your inbox. Needs a one-time Google client ID and Margin served over https.

3 · Files

An `.ics` invite, a `.csv` export, a `.txt` list. Open a file, or drag one in on a computer.

4 · Share

Share a page or some text to Margin from another app, or open the link ending in `?text=`.

Nothing is added behind your back. Everything arrives as a suggestion with a line saying why. *Add* files it, *Add & edit* opens it, *Skip* drops it for good. The same message is never read in twice.

09 What Margin looks for in an email

IT NOTICES

AND SUGGESTS

A renewal or expiry date

“your policy expires on 3 Nov”

An expiry item on the radar, with your 60 / 30 / 7-day warnings.

A date with a time

“confirmed for 22 Sep at 4:30pm”

A hard item on that day, ready for the → *Calendar* button.

An amount and a bill

“invoice · AED 4,500”

A *Pay ...* item, with the amount and reference kept in the note.

A line asking you for something

“please confirm by Thursday”

That line as its own item, dated from the words in it.

Mail you sent yourself

set your address under *Sources*

A *Waiting on* entry with a chase date, instead of a task.

Sender, subject, references, links

Kept with the item, so “where did this come from?” is always one tap away.

Each suggestion is filed into an area the same way typed captures are, and the title stays editable on the card before you add it.

10 Living with it

ARRIVES

A badge on the *Sources* tab, and a card on *Today* saying how many are waiting.

→

EVENING

Triage now opens with *What arrived* — clear it in a minute.

→

FILED

Items show a small ☒ or ■ with the sender, and *Notes* can filter by source.

→

SEARCHABLE

The *Notes* search reads the original text too, not just your titles.

11 · WHERE YOUR MAIL GOES

Nowhere. Pasted text is read on the phone and never leaves it. With Gmail connected, your browser asks Google for your messages directly — read-only, no sending, no deleting — and the sign-in token is kept in memory only, so it disappears when you close the app. Margin keeps a short snippet of the original with each item you accept; turn that off under *Settings* → *Sources*. The list of messages already seen is only used to stop the same email arriving twice, and *Forget* clears it.